

Jesus tells the parable of the talents.

Matthew 25:14-30; Luke 19:12-27

One day Jesus told about a rich man who had three servants. This man had to go on a long trip. While he was gone, he wanted his servants to make more money for him.

The man gave the first servant five talents. (A talent was a large amount of money.) He gave the second servant two talents, and he gave the third servant one talent. Then he left on his trip.

The servant with five talents went right to work. He used the money to make five more talents! The servant who had gotten two talents also got right to work. He may have bought and sold animals or planted food to sell. Whatever he did, he ended up with four talents—twice what the rich man had given him.

But the last servant was afraid that the money would get lost or stolen. So he dug a hole in the ground and buried the money!

The rich man came back from his trip. He called together his servants to see what they had done with their money. The first servant told that he had gotten five more talents. The second servant showed that he had gotten two more talents. The man was very pleased with their hard work. He said he would give them even more to take care of.

Then the last servant said he had buried the talent in the ground. The rich man was angry! He said he wanted his money to be used, not hidden away.

Jesus told about the rich man to help us know that God wants us to use what He gives us to do good things.